



External HDDs

External drives is a category that did not have many innovations so to speak over last year. SuperSpeed USB 3.0 was the default interface on majority of the external drives. Considering all motherboards these days, barring the extremely budget ones, sport USB 3.0 drives, it makes sense for the external HDD industry to move in that direction. We did come across a couple of Thunderbolt drives which we found to be pointless as their speeds were limited due to the mechanical internal drives.

External HDD makers continued to concentrate on the aesthetics of the drive in order to make it stand out. Last year we had the Seagate Slim drive, which got company this year with Toshiba's Slim drive. Seagate also had an external HDD with a Wi-Fi adapter within it, to be used along with your tablet or smartphone. Capacities for external HDDs reached 2 TB for non-powered drives and 4 TB for powered drives.

Zero1 Winner

Transcend StoreJet 35T3

The Zero1 award for the external HDD was bagged by Transcend StoreJet 35T3 (2 TB) for its fabulous transfer speeds across all tests. In real-life tests, it crossed over 140 MB/s in both sequential read and write operations whereas it gave over 100 MB/s in assorted read transfer. It offered a great cost per GB as well.

Worthy Mention

Hitachi Mobile Touro Pro 750 GB

Among the non-powered external drives, the Touro Mobile Pro is the fastest drive thanks to a 7200 RPM internal drive. None of the other portable drives we tested this year came close to the Hitachi drives performance. It easily crosses over 115 MB/s in sequential tests. It also offers a 3 GB cloud storage option along with the regular list of backup and encryption utilities, it makes for a great purchase if performance is what you are after.



◀ **EXTERNAL HDDs:**
TRANSCEND STOREJET 35T3

Price: ₹8,000



Hitachi Mobile Touro Pro 750 GB

Price: ₹8,800



Kingston Data Traveler HyperX 3.0

Price: ₹18,000



▲ **FLASH DRIVES:**
SANDISK EXTREME USB 3.0 (64 GB)

Price: ₹5,189

Flash Drives

While USB 3.0 has become mainstream with flash drives as well, there are cheaper USB 2.0 drives still selling in the market. Capacities have skyrocketed in this space from what we saw last year. We tested pen drives which offered capacities of 8 GB and above and were shocked out of our wits to find a 256 GB Kingston Data Traveler HyperX 3.0 drive in our midst.

Zero1 Winner

SanDisk Extreme USB 3.0 (64 GB)

This actually did prove to be an Extreme drive in the true sense of the word, what with real-life sequential speeds of over 150 MB/s! Yes, it was quite an insane speed for a pen drive. The black slider body looks really good. So if raw performance is what you are after the SanDisk Extreme is the perfect drive for you.

Worthy Mention

Kingston Data Traveler HyperX 3.0

Kingston Data Traveler series of pen drives was great, but when you mash up that series with the HyperX series – offering better build, great looks, and a humongous capacity, you are looking at a stunner. This 256 GB drive does deserve a worthy mention despite its prohibitive pricing (₹18,000) for the sheer fact that it not only offers such huge capacity, but performed second only to the SanDisk Extreme drive.